

around it. When you think of .NET, you also think about the new research technology coming out like the F Sharp programming language—completely new products but you can still connect to your .NET libraries and USBs. This is the magnitude of Microsoft's open source commitment. Our developers are incredible. There are troops of people who have done really amazing things with .NET.

RC: With respect to the Azure Marketplace, are there any specifics that might impact developers and vendors that you would like to share?

José : There are traditional partners who are highly successful, and then there are disruptive IT companies or the cloud service vendors and many others from markets like India, etc. We really want to connect the latter with the financially big partners to help them grow—in India, China, various other parts of Asia, Latin America, Middle East and Europe. So how do we help them? The answer is the Azure Marketplace. You now have a solution—you have a portal that can control the Linux machines running on Azure, etc. Vendors and service providers just need to put their products on Azure Marketplace and sell them to the big companies—

one never knows who it's going to be. It could be Hitachi, 3M, etc, so Azure Marketplace is a lot about connecting with the enterprise customers across the globe. To do that, we need to really make the marketplace global, which is what we've done with Azure.

RC: Are there multiple marketplaces that Microsoft has built? Are these integrated or does one have to go to each one separately?

Balaji: Currently, we have three independent marketplaces. One for the cloud, one for the phone, and one for the desktop. But our roadmap for Windows 10, which is what we now have, is that the Windows Phone and Windows Operating System will merge. So basically, it's one store for the phone and desktop (devices), and one for the cloud.

RC: Is there a revenue sharing model in Azure Marketplace?

José : In the cloud, the economics is slightly different because we are not selling an application on our competitor's platform—we are selling it in ours. Vendors and service providers pay us for the storage and the network. 

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